

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

(STANDARD GK)

INDIA & THE WORLD

MODULE – 21

UPSC / GR 1

IBPS / SSC

GENERAL

RAMSAR SITES ... PART - 1



ABOUT THE RAMSAR CONVENTION ON WETLANDS



Peatlands



Lagoon



Coral Reefs

*Wetlands are among the most diverse
and productive ecosystems.*

- 1** It is an intergovernmental treaty that provides framework for conservation and wise use of wetlands and their resources.
- 2** This was adopted in Iranian city of Ramsar in 1971.
- 3** It came into force in 1975.
- 4** It is through local and national actions and international cooperation, as a contribution towards achieving sustainable development throughout the World.



WHICH QUALIFIES FOR WETLANDS?



Marshes



Mangroves



Lake



River

- 1 They include lakes and rivers, underground aquifers, swamps and marshes, wet grasslands.
- 2 They also include tidal flats, mangroves and other coastal areas, coral reefs.
- 3 Human made sites like fish ponds, rice paddies, reservoirs, salt pans are also part of wetlands.

THE THREE PILLARS OF THE CONVENTION

- 1 Working towards the wise use of all wetlands.



- 2 Designating suitable wetlands for the list of Ramsar for effective management.



- 3 Cooperating internationally on trans-boundary wetlands, shared wetland systems and shared species.



WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY WISE USE OF WETLANDS?



- 1** The wise use is maintaining their ecological character, through the implementation of ecosystem approaches, within the context of sustainable development.
- 2** It is conservation and sustainable use of wetlands and all the service they provide for the benefit of people and nature.
- 3** The parties commit to work towards the wise use of all the wetlands and water resources through national plans, policies and legislation management actions and public education.

INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION PARTNERS



1 The Ramsar Convention works closely with six other organizations known as International Organization Partners (IOPs)

2 The Six Organizations are –

- 1) Bird Life International
- 2) IUCN
- 3) IWMI
- 4) Wetlands International
- 5) WWF International
- 6) WWT

- Largest freshwater lake in India.
- Fed by the Jhelum River, formed because of tectonic activity.
- Marshes of floating vegetation, particularly water chestnut, provide important source of revenue for the State Government as well as fodder for livestock.
- Supports fishing industry.
- Important for wintering, staging and breeding birds.



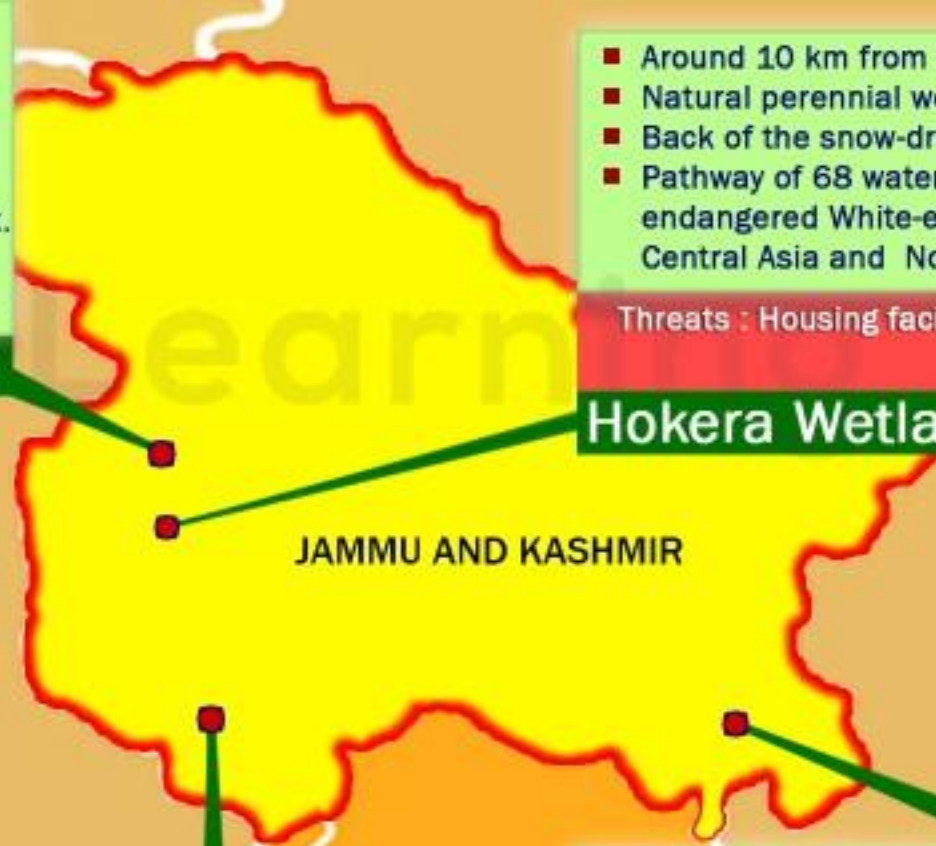
Wular Lake



Surinsar-Mansar Lakes

- Sacred to Hindus.
- Freshwater lake in semi-arid Punjab Plains, adjoining the Jhelum River Basin.
- High in micro nutrients.
- Socially and culturally very important with many temples around.
- It supports variety of fishes.

Threats : Increasing visitors, agricultural runoff, bathing and cremation rituals.



JAMMU AND KASHMIR

Hokera Wetland

- Around 10 km from Srinagar.
- Natural perennial wetland in the Jhelum basin.
- Back of the snow-draped Pir Panjal ranges.
- Pathway of 68 waterfowl species like Large Egret, Tufted Duck and endangered White-eyed Pochard, coming from Siberia, China, Central Asia and Northern Europe.

Threats : Housing facilities, littered garbage, and demand for increasing tourist facilities.



Tsomoriri

- Freshwater to brackish water lake lying at 4,595 m above sea level.
- Only breeding ground outside China for Black-necked crane, only breeding ground for Bar-headed geese.
- Barley fields are the highest cultivated land in the World.
- 400-year-old Korzok monastery attracts tourists.
- Sacred to local Buddhists.
- Local community dedicated this as WWF Sacred Gift for the Living Planet in recognition of WWF-India's project work there.

Threats: Opening the area to western tourists may spoil the unspoiled destination.





- It is high altitude lake in upper Chandra valley flowing to the Chandra river near the Kunzam pass, joining the Himalayan and Pir Panjal ranges.
- It supports Snow Leopard.
- Refuge for many species like Snow Cock, Chukor, Golden Eagle, Red Fox, Himalayan Ibex and Blue Sheep.
- 65% of the larger catchment is degraded forest due to overgrazing by the nomadic herdsman and 35% is covered by grasslands.
- Spiti Forest Department is the custodian

Threats : Fragile and Sparse vegetation, littering waste, summer trekking etc.



Chandertal Wetland



Pong Dam Lake

- Created in 1975 on the Beas River.
- Monsoon-season flood prevention, both in the surroundings and downstream due to water regulation, groundwater recharge, silt trapping and prevention of soil erosion are important aspects.
- Nature Conservation Education Centre is found on the island of Ramsar.
- Protected through participatory approaches and community awareness.
- Is well suited to "community-based ecotourism".

HIMACHAL PRADESH

Renuka Wetland

- Fed by small stream flowing from the lower Himalayan to the Giri river.
- High religious significance, named after the mother of Hindu sage Parshuram, visited by thousands of pilgrims and tourists.
- Managed by the Shimla Forest Department.
- Conservation measures include community awareness, prevention of silt influx from eroded slopes, massive plantation in the catchment etc.





- It was formed by constructing the headworks across the Sutlej river, in 1953.
- A shallow water reservoir with thirteen islands, at the confluence of two rivers i.e., Sutlej and Beas.
- Floating vegetation covers 70% of the lake.
- Important site for breeding, wintering and staging birds, supporting over 2,00,000 during migration.
- The lake is leased on an annual basis to commercial fishery organizations.

Harike Lake

- Man-made wetland due to the construction of barrage for diversion of water from Sutlej River.
- Important breeding place for nationally protected Smooth Indian Otter, Hog Deer, Sambar and several reptiles.
- About 150 species of local and migratory birds are supported.

Threats : Deforested local hills leading to siltation, increasing industrialization and pollutants, invasive weeds.

Ropar



Kanjli

- A permanent stream, Kali Bein, was converted by construction of small barrage in 1870.
- Acts as key regulator for groundwater discharge and recharge.
- Plays crucial role in agriculture.
- Very important from religious perspective, associated with the first guru of Sikhs, Shri Guru Nanak Dev Ji.

Threats : Invasive water hyacinth, increasing pollution levels, deforestation, excessive grazing.



PUNJAB

NEPAL

Rajasthan

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